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ESOL Exam Preparation Lessons: E3 Reading, E2 and E1 Speaking & Listening

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Overview

Thirty-nine two-hour lessons, thirteen per exam, each built from four or five long activities with printable handouts and answer keys. Lessons 1 to 3 for each exam are on this tab. Lessons 4 to 13 are on the three tabs that follow, and each set ends with a full mock.

Lesson	Exam	Focus	Exam part it prepares
E3 R1	Entry 3 Reading	Main points and purpose	AC1.1, AC2.1
E3 R2	Entry 3 Reading	Pronouns, word meaning, finding details	AC1.3, AC1.4, AC3.1
E3 R3	Entry 3 Reading	Ordering events, alphabetical order, timed practice paper	AC1.2, AC4.1, whole paper
E2 SL1	Entry 2 Speaking and Listening	Asking for personal information; the short talk	Tasks 1 and 2
E2 SL2	Entry 2 Speaking and Listening	Describing people, places and things	Task 3
E2 SL3	Entry 2 Speaking and Listening	Listening and discussion; full mock	Task 4, whole exam
E1 SL1	Entry 1 Speaking and Listening	Asking for personal information	Task 1
E1 SL2	Entry 1 Speaking and Listening	The short talk; describing a picture	Tasks 2 and 3
E1 SL3	Entry 1 Speaking and Listening	Listening and discussion; full mock	Task 4, whole exam

Exam formats the lessons follow

- **Entry 3 Reading:** 60 minutes, three tasks, 21 questions, as in the Set L sample paper in your project files. Each task tests the same seven criteria with multiple choice, true or false, short written answers and alphabetical order. Lessons 4 to 13 are in the second tab and end with a full 21-question mock.
- **Entry 1 Speaking and Listening:** about 22 minutes, in pairs, four tasks. Task 1 personal information (4 minutes), Task 2 a talk on an everyday topic with two questions from the partner (4 minutes), Task 3 describing pictures (4 minutes), Task 4 two short recordings with a yes/no question and a detail question each, then a short discussion (10 minutes). ESB Entry 1

- **Entry 2 Speaking and Listening:** about 25 minutes, in pairs, the same four tasks at a higher level. ESB Entry 2

Working assumptions

- Each lesson is planned for two hours. Timings are in brackets after each activity title.
- Learners have no headphones, so every listening text is a script for you to read aloud.
- People and organisations in the texts are invented. The London settings are real.
- Task 3 lessons need printed photos. Each lesson lists exactly which ones to bring.
- Handouts carry no exam-board branding. Practice papers have name and date lines.

Entry 3 Reading, Lesson 1: Main points and purpose

Learners finish able to say what a whole text and each paragraph is about, and why it was written. These are AC1.1 and AC2.1, two of the criteria learners most often fail.

Materials: Handouts 1A, 1B and 1C, one per learner. Six blank slips of paper per pair.

Activity 1: Why did someone write this? (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Write six verbs on the board in a column: *describe, advise, warn, advertise, inform, instruct*. Say each one and have the class repeat it.
2. Give a spoken example of each without naming the verb. Learners call out which verb it is. Use: “Mind the gap” (warn); “Half-price trainers this weekend only” (advertise); “You should register with a GP” (advise); “Turn left at the lights” (instruct); “The class starts at 9.30” (inform); “My street is long and quiet, with a bakery on the corner” (describe).
3. Ask where learners saw English writing on the way to college today. Collect ten examples on the board, such as bus signs, shop windows, texts and letters. For each one, the class decides the purpose and you write the verb next to it.
4. Draw out the language clues and add them to the board: *should* and *it is a good idea to* signal advice; a verb at the start of the sentence signals instructions; *danger, beware, do not* signal a warning; prices and *free, new, best* signal advertising; adjectives and *there is* signal description.
5. Tell learners that one question in the exam always asks this, with four verbs to choose from.

Activity 2: Six short texts (25 minutes)

1. Hand out 1A. Learners read alone for three minutes without writing.
2. In pairs, they choose the purpose of each text and underline the words that helped them decide.
3. Take feedback one text at a time. For each, ask a pair for the answer, then ask a second pair for the clue words. Insist on the clue words every time: the habit of proving an answer is the point of the activity.
4. Extension for fast pairs: change text 3 so that it warns instead of advises.

Activity 3: What is each paragraph about? (30 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Hand out 1B face down. Tell learners they have 30 seconds to look at it. Turn over, time them, turn back. Ask: What is it about? Who is in it? Accept anything. Praise any correct guess and point out that they got it without reading every word.
2. Teach the method on the board: read the title, then the first sentence of each paragraph, then stop and say the topic in three or four words.
3. Read paragraph 1 aloud. Ask for the topic in four words or fewer. Write suggestions on the board and choose the best together.
4. Pairs now read the whole text and match the headings on 1B to the paragraphs. Warn them that one heading is not needed.
5. Feedback: for each paragraph, ask which sentence gave the answer. Then ask why heading F fits nowhere. The text never mentions cost.

Activity 4: Exam questions (25 minutes)

1. Hand out 1C. Learners answer alone in 12 minutes, in silence, as in the exam.
2. Pairs compare. Where they disagree, each must point to the line that supports their answer.
3. Class feedback. For every question, ask why one of the wrong options is wrong. Example for question 1: option C is true, the shops did throw food away, but it is one detail and not the main idea. Name this trap clearly: a true detail is not the main point.

Activity 5: Write it, swap it, guess it (20 minutes)

1. Give each pair a secret purpose verb on a slip of paper.
2. Each pair writes a two-sentence text about the college with that purpose. Example for *warn*: “The stairs are wet. Please use the lift.”
3. Pairs pass their text to the next pair, who write the purpose and the clue word underneath, then pass it on again. Continue for three passes.
4. Read out four or five texts. The class votes on the purpose. Finish by asking each learner to tell their partner the two things they must do with a purpose question: find the clue words, and choose the verb that fits the whole text.

Handout 1A: Why was it written?

Read each text. Write one word from the box next to it. Underline the words that helped you.

describe | advise | warn | advertise | inform | instruct

	Text	Purpose
1	Thieves work on this bus route. Keep your phone and bag where you can see them.	
2	Fresh bread baked every morning. Buy two loaves and get one free this week at Sami’s Bakery.	
3	If you have a cough for more than three weeks, you should see your doctor. It is also a good idea to rest and drink plenty of water.	
4	Press the green button. Wait for the beep. Then hold your card on the reader.	
5	London Fields is a large park in Hackney. It has tall trees, a cricket pitch and an outdoor swimming pool.	
6	The library will close at 1pm on Friday 13 November for staff training. It will open as normal on Saturday.	

Handout 1B: A Free Meal and a Friendly Face

1 Every Wednesday evening, a church hall in Hackney fills with the smell of cooking. This is the Well Street Community Kitchen. It opened six years ago. Volunteers cook a hot meal for anyone who wants one. You do not need to book and you do not need to pay.

2 The kitchen is run by Amina Yusuf. She started it with two friends and one large pot. Now she has a team of twenty volunteers. Some of them cook, and others serve the food or wash up. Many volunteers first came to the kitchen as guests. They wanted to give something back.

3 The food comes from local shops and markets. At the end of the day, shops often have bread, fruit and vegetables that they cannot sell. In the past, they threw this food away. Now a volunteer collects it by bicycle every Wednesday morning. The cooks never know what will arrive, so the menu is different every week.

4 About eighty people eat at the kitchen each week. Some guests live alone and come for the company. Others are new to London and want to practise their English. “I came for the soup,” says one guest, Daniel, “but I stayed because of the people. I have made real friends here.”

5 The kitchen always needs more help. You do not need to be a good cook. If you can spare two hours on a Wednesday, come to the hall at four o’clock and ask for Amina.

Match a heading to each paragraph. There is one extra heading.

- A. Where the ingredients come from
- B. How you can join the team
- C. The person in charge and her helpers
- D. What the kitchen is and when it happens
- E. Who comes to eat, and why
- F. How much the meals cost to make

Paragraph 1: ____ Paragraph 2: ____ Paragraph 3: ____ Paragraph 4: ____ Paragraph 5: ____

Handout 1C: Questions on A Free Meal and a Friendly Face

Name: _____ Date: _____

Circle A, B, C or D.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- A. A woman who learned to cook in London
- B. A weekly free dinner run by local people
- C. Shops that put good food in the bin
- D. A restaurant that is looking for customers

2. What is paragraph 3 mainly about?

- A. Why the dinners are free
- B. How the helpers travel to the hall
- C. How the kitchen gets what it cooks
- D. Which markets are the cheapest

3. The main point of paragraph 4 is that guests:

- A. visit mostly to learn a language
- B. come for more than just a meal
- C. usually arrive in large groups
- D. like soup more than other dishes

4. Why did the writer include paragraph 5?

- A. To explain how the project began
- B. To thank the cooks for their work
- C. To ask readers to give some of their time
- D. To say when dinner is served

5. The text:

- A. describes a local project
- B. advises people how to save money
- C. warns people about wasting food
- D. advertises a new café

Answer key, Lesson 1

- **1A:** 1 warn (thieves, keep). 2 advertise (fresh, get one free). 3 advise (should, a good idea). 4 instruct (press, wait, hold). 5 describe (large, tall, it has). 6 inform (will close, date and time).
- **1B headings:** 1 D, 2 C, 3 A, 4 E, 5 B. F is not needed.
- **1C:** 1 B, 2 C, 3 B, 4 C, 5 A.

Entry 3 Reading, Lesson 2: Pronouns, word meaning and finding details

Learners finish able to say who or what a pronoun refers to, work out an unknown word from the sentences around it, and find a detail when the question uses different words from the text. These are AC1.3, AC1.4 and AC3.1.

Materials: Handouts 2A, 2B and 2C, one per learner. Coloured pens or highlighters if available.

Activity 1: Who is 'he'? What is 'it'? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Write on the board: *Rosa has a brother. He lives in Leeds. She visits him every month.* Ask who *He* is, who *She* is and who *him* is. Draw an arrow from each pronoun back to its noun.
2. Teach the rule in three steps and leave it on the board: look back, not forward; check singular or plural; check person or thing.
3. Write a harder example: *The manager gave the keys to the new tenant. He told him to keep them safe.* Ask who *He* is. Let learners argue. Establish that the person doing the first action usually continues, so *He* is the manager and *him* is the tenant. *Them* is the keys, because it is plural.
4. Hand out 2A. Do item 1 together, drawing the arrows on the board. Learners complete items 2 to 5 alone, drawing arrows on the paper before they write anything.
5. Feedback at the board. Invite learners up to draw the arrows. For item 2, stress that *it* appears twice and both mean the letter.

Activity 2: Read and track the pronouns (20 minutes)

1. Hand out 2B. Learners read the text once, silently, for the story. Ask two gist questions: What did Farid get? What does he do on Saturdays now?
2. Read the text aloud while learners follow. Stop at each bold pronoun and ask the class to shout the noun. Do not confirm yet.
3. Pairs answer the pronoun questions on 2C, section A. They must draw the arrow in the text first.
4. Feedback. For question 2, ask why the answer is not the piece of paper. Answer: a piece of paper cannot be ready after three Saturdays of repairs. Meaning has to make sense as well as grammar.

Activity 3: Guess the word from its neighbours (30 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Write *rusty* on the board. Ask who knows it. Tell those who do to stay quiet.
2. Ask the others to find the word in paragraph 3 and read the sentences before and after. Collect clues on the board: the bikes are old; Farid must repair it first. Ask: is a rusty bicycle in good or bad condition? Establish the meaning from the clues alone.
3. Give the method a name, *read around the word*, and write three steps: read the sentence before and after; decide if the word is good or bad, a thing or an action; try each option in the sentence and see which makes sense.
4. Pairs complete the clue table on 2C, section B, for five words. They write the clue first and their guess second. No phones or dictionaries.

5. Pairs then answer the multiple-choice questions underneath.
6. Feedback. For each word, ask for the clue before the answer. Then test the method: substitute the chosen option into the sentence and read it aloud. Does it still make sense?

Activity 4: Find the detail when the words are different (25 minutes)

1. Write on the board: *Text: nearly an hour. Question: almost 60 minutes.* Explain that exam questions rarely copy the text. Learners must look for the same idea in different words.
2. Quick oral matching. Say a phrase and learners find the matching words in the text: *a place to stay for people with no home* (hostel); *someone who works for free* (volunteer); *every week on the same day* (every Saturday); *without paying* (free).
3. Learners answer 2C, section C, alone in ten minutes. Beside each answer they write the paragraph number where they found it.
4. Pairs compare paragraph numbers before answers. Class feedback: for each question, one learner reads out the sentence from the text and another says which words in the question mean the same.

Activity 5: Be the examiner (20 minutes)

1. Each pair writes one new four-option question about the text: either a pronoun question or a detail question. The rule is that the question must not copy more than two words in a row from the text.
2. Pairs swap questions with another pair and answer them.
3. Choose three good questions and put them on the board. The class answers and says which wrong option was the most tempting, and why.
4. Close by asking each learner to finish the sentence: “When I do not know a word in the exam, I will…”

Handout 2A: Follow the arrows

Draw an arrow from each bold word to the person or thing it means. Then write the answer.

1. Maria has two brothers. **They** live in Leeds. They = _____
2. The council sent Ahmed a letter. **He** put **it** in his bag and forgot about **it**. He = _____ it = _____
3. Nasra met her neighbours at the market. **She** invited **them** for tea. She = _____ them = _____
4. The bus was late and the passengers were cold. When **it** finally arrived, **they** cheered. it = _____ they = _____
5. Mr Chen gave the students a form. **He** asked **them** to return **it** by Friday. He = _____ them = _____ it = _____

Handout 2B: Two Wheels and a New Start

1 When Farid Rahimi arrived in London two years ago, he knew nobody. He lived in a hostel in Dalston and spent most of his money on bus fares. His English class was four miles away, so he travelled for nearly an hour each way.

2 One day his teacher, Mrs Okafor, told him about a bicycle workshop near the canal. **It** gives old bikes to people who need them. She wrote the address on a piece of paper and gave it to him. He went there the next Saturday.

3 The workshop was noisy and crowded. A mechanic called Rosa showed Farid a rusty blue bicycle. “It is yours,” she said, “but first you must repair it.” Farid had never fixed anything before. Rosa was patient. She taught him how to change a tyre and mend the brakes. After three Saturdays, **it** was ready.

4 The bicycle changed Farid’s life. He now gets to college in twenty minutes and he saves about fifteen pounds a week. He also feels healthier. At first, the busy roads frightened him, so he took a free cycling lesson from the council. Now he rides with confidence.

5 Farid still goes to the workshop every Saturday, but these days he is a volunteer. He helps new visitors choose a bike and shows **them** how to look after it. “Rosa gave me more than a bicycle,” he says. “She gave me a skill. I want to pass **it** on.”

Handout 2C: Questions on Two Wheels and a New Start

Name: _____ Date: _____

Section A: Pronouns. Circle A, B, C or D.

1. In paragraph 2, ‘It’ means:

- A. the canal
- B. the workshop
- C. the English class
- D. the hostel

2. In paragraph 3, ‘it was ready’ means:

- A. the tyre
- B. the piece of paper
- C. the bicycle
- D. the workshop

3. In paragraph 5, ‘them’ means:

- A. the bikes
- B. Rosa and Farid
- C. the Saturdays
- D. new visitors

4. In paragraph 5, ‘pass it on’ means pass on:

- A. the skill
- B. the bicycle
- C. the workshop
- D. the address

Section B: Word meaning. Find each word in the text. Write the clue, then your guess.

Word	Paragraph	Clue in the text	My guess
crowded	3		
patient	3		
mend	3		
frightened	4		
with confidence	4		

5. ‘Patient’ means:

- A. in a hurry
- B. calm and happy to wait
- C. unwell
- D. very strict

6. ‘Mend’ means:

- A. buy
- B. clean

- C. make something work again
- D. test

7. ‘Frightened him’ means:

- A. made him bored
- B. made him late
- C. made him angry
- D. made him afraid

8. ‘With confidence’ means:

- A. very slowly
- B. without fear
- C. every day
- D. with other people

Section C: Details. Circle A, B, C or D. Write the paragraph number next to your answer.

9. Before he had the bike, how long was Farid’s journey to class?

- A. About twenty minutes
- B. Almost sixty minutes
- C. Two hours
- D. Four hours

10. Who first told Farid about the workshop?

- A. A mechanic
- B. Someone at the hostel
- C. The person who taught his class
- D. Someone from the council

11. What did Farid have to do before the bike was his?

- A. Pay fifteen pounds
- B. Do the repairs himself
- C. Pass a cycling test
- D. Work for free for three weeks

12. Why did Farid take a lesson from the council?

- A. He was nervous in traffic
- B. He wanted to become a mechanic
- C. His bike kept breaking
- D. The college asked him to

13. What does Farid do at the workshop now?

- A. He sells bikes
- B. He learns to change tyres
- C. He helps people who are new there
- D. He teaches English

Answer key, Lesson 2

- **2A:** 1 the two brothers. 2 Ahmed; the letter. 3 Nasra; her neighbours. 4 the bus; the passengers. 5 Mr Chen; the students; the form.
- **2C Section A:** 1 B, 2 C, 3 D, 4 A.

- **2C Section B clues:** crowded (noisy, a workshop full of people); patient (Farid had never fixed anything, but she taught him); mend (you must repair it, change a tyre); frightened (busy roads, so he took a lesson); with confidence (after the lesson, the opposite of frightened). 5 B, 6 C, 7 D, 8 B.
- **2C Section C:** 9 B (paragraph 1), 10 C (paragraph 2), 11 B (paragraph 3), 12 A (paragraph 4), 13 C (paragraph 5).

Entry 3 Reading, Lesson 3: Ordering tasks and a timed practice paper

Learners finish able to put events in time order, put words in alphabetical order to the third letter, and complete a full paper under exam conditions. This covers AC1.2 and AC4.1 and rehearses all seven criteria.

Materials: Handouts 3A and 3B, one per learner. Handout 3C, the practice paper, one per learner. The 15 word cards from 3B, section 2, written large on A5 paper.

Activity 1: What happened first? (25 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Tell the class a 30-second story about your morning, out of order: “I got to college at nine. Before that, I missed my bus. After I woke up, I could not find my keys.” Ask what happened first. Let them work it out.
2. Board the time words learners heard, then add more: *first, then, next, after that, later, finally, before, after, when, by September*. Mark *before* and *after* in a different colour. These two cause most of the mistakes.
3. Write: *Before breakfast, she washed the uniform.* Ask which came first, breakfast or washing. Establish that the first event in the sentence is not always the first event in time. Repeat with: *She phoned the school after she arrived.*
4. Hand out 3A. Learners read the short text and number the events alone.
5. Pairs compare, then check together. For each event, ask for the time word that proves its place.
6. Teach the exam routine: underline every date, month and time word in the text first; number the events lightly in pencil; then check that the first event given in the exam matches your order.

Activity 2: Alphabetical order to the third letter (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Give five learners the set 1 word cards. They stand in alphabetical order at the front. The class corrects them.
2. Repeat with set 2, where all the words start with *c*. Ask how to decide. Elicit: look at the second letter. Write the words in a column on the board and circle the second letter of each.
3. Repeat with set 3, where all words start with *st*. Circle the third letter. For *stall* and *station*, go to the fourth letter.
4. Teach the paper method for the exam: write the alphabet across the top of the page; cross off each word as you use it; count that you have five words at the end.
5. Learners complete 3B alone, writing the words in the empty tables. Check in pairs, then on the board.

Activity 3: Timed practice paper (45 minutes)

1. Set the room for an exam: desks apart, phones away, no talking. Explain that the real paper allows 60 minutes for a similar text. Today they have 40 so that there is time to review.
2. Hand out 3C. Remind learners of the order to work in: read the title and the first sentence of each paragraph; read the whole text once; then answer.
3. Write the finish time on the board. Give a warning at 20 minutes and at 35 minutes.
4. Do not help with vocabulary. Note which questions individuals get stuck on. This tells you what to revisit.
5. Fast finishers check each answer by finding the supporting line and writing the paragraph number beside it.

Activity 4: Prove it (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Learners swap papers and mark in a different colour as you go through the answers.
2. For each question, do not give the answer yourself. Ask one learner for the letter and a second learner for the line in the text that proves it.
3. For questions 2 and 6, ask which wrong option tempted people and why it is wrong. For question 3, write the months on the board in a line and place each event under its month.
4. Take a show of hands for each question to see who got it right. Record the two weakest questions for the class.
5. Each learner writes a personal target on the top of the paper: “Next time I will…”

Activity 5: Exam day routine (10 minutes)

1. Elicit and board a five-step routine: read the title; read the first sentences; read everything once; answer the easy questions first; check each answer against the text.
2. Tell learners there are no marks lost for a wrong answer, so they should never leave a question blank.
3. Learners copy the routine onto the back of their practice paper to keep.

Handout 3A: Hawa’s Morning

Hawa got up at six o’clock. Before breakfast, she washed her son’s school shirt. After they ate, she took him to school. Then she caught the bus to college. She arrived late because the bus broke down on the way. At lunchtime she phoned the school to check on her son.

Number the events from 1 to 6 in the order they happened.

Event	Number
Hawa and her son ate breakfast.	
Hawa phoned the school.	
Hawa got out of bed.	
The bus stopped working.	
Hawa washed a shirt.	
Hawa left her son at school.	

Handout 3B: Alphabetical order

Section 1. Write the alphabet here: _____

Section 2. Write each set of words in alphabetical order in the table.

Set 1: market, bus, hostel, teacher, garden

Set 2: college, class, canal, card, cycle

Set 3: street, station, stop, student, stall

	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Handout 3C: Practice paper

Name: _____ Date: _____

Read the text and answer all the questions. You have 40 minutes.

The Garden Behind the Hostel

1 Behind a hostel in Hackney there is a small garden. Two years ago it was only a yard full of rubbish. Today it grows tomatoes, beans, herbs and flowers. The people who live in the hostel made it themselves.

2 The idea came from Lucia Moreno. She moved into the hostel in January and missed her mother's garden in Colombia. In March she asked the manager, Mr Bailey, if residents could use the yard. **He** agreed, but he said there was no money for it.

3 First, Lucia and five neighbours cleared the rubbish. It took them two weekends. Then a local garden centre gave them soil and some old tools. In April they planted the first seeds in wooden boxes. They watered them every evening after dinner.

4 The summer was difficult. In June, snails ate most of the young plants, and the group had to start again. In July there was no rain for three weeks. However, nobody gave up. By September they had enough vegetables to cook a meal for the whole hostel.

5 The garden has done more than produce food. Residents who never spoke to each other now work side by side. Children help with the watering. "People are calmer," says Mr Bailey. "They have something to look after."

6 Next year the group plans to build a small greenhouse. Lucia could move to a flat soon, but she will come back to visit. "I planted this garden," she says. "I want to see it grow."

Question 1. Who is 'He' in paragraph 2? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. Lucia's father
- B. Mr Bailey
- C. A neighbour
- D. A worker at the garden centre

Question 2. What is the main point of paragraph 4? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. London usually has bad weather.
- B. The group had problems but carried on.
- C. Snails are dangerous for vegetables.
- D. The hostel cooked dinner together every week.

Question 3. Put these events in the order they happened. The first one is done for you.

Event	Order
Lucia came to live at the hostel.	1
Snails destroyed many plants.	
Lucia asked for permission to use the yard.	
Everyone in the hostel shared food from the garden.	
The neighbours took the rubbish away.	
The group put seeds into boxes.	

Question 4. How did the group get their soil? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. Mr Bailey paid for it.
- B. They bought it at a market.
- C. A nearby business donated it.

- D. Lucia's family sent it.

Question 5. In paragraph 4, what does 'gave up' mean? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. stopped trying
- B. went home
- C. got angry
- D. felt tired

Question 6. The text: Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. advertises a garden centre
- B. describes how some neighbours built a garden
- C. warns people about snails
- D. advises readers how to grow tomatoes

Question 7. Write these words in alphabetical order: garden, flowers, greenhouse, group, food

	Word
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

Question 8. In paragraph 6, what does 'could' mean? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. must
- B. might
- C. wants to
- D. did

Question 9. Which sentence is correct? Circle A, B, C or D.

- A. The garden cost the hostel a lot of money.
- B. Lucia built the garden alone.
- C. There was a dry period in the summer.
- D. The first seeds went in during January.

Question 10. Write two problems the gardeners had in the summer.

Answer key, Lesson 3

- **3A:** got out of bed 1; washed a shirt 2; ate breakfast 3; left her son at school 4; the bus stopped working 5; phoned the school 6.
- **3B:** Set 1: bus, garden, hostel, market, teacher. Set 2: canal, card, class, college, cycle. Set 3: stall, station, stop, street, student.
- **3C:** 1 B. 2 B. 3 asked for permission 2, took the rubbish away 3, put seeds into boxes 4, snails destroyed plants 5, shared food 6. 4 C. 5 A. 6 B. 7 flowers, food, garden, greenhouse, group. 8 B. 9 C. 10 snails ate the plants; there was no rain for three weeks.
- **Criteria covered by 3C:** Q1 AC1.3, Q2 AC1.1, Q3 AC1.2, Q4 AC3.1, Q5 AC1.4, Q6 AC2.1, Q7 AC4.1, Q8 AC1.4, Q9 and Q10 AC3.1.

Entry 2 Speaking and Listening, Lesson 1: Personal information and the short talk

Learners finish able to ask a partner accurate questions about their life, give longer answers, speak alone on an everyday topic for about a minute, and ask two follow-up questions after a partner's talk. This prepares Tasks 1 and 2.

Materials: Handouts E2-1A and E2-1B, one per learner. Topic cards from E2-1B cut up, one set per pair. A timer.

Activity 1: Build the question (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Write on the board: *Where / live?* Ask for the full question. Write *Where do you live?* and box the word *do*. Ask what is wrong with *Where you live?* Most learners drop the helper word, and the assessor listens for it.
2. Board a three-column frame: question word, helper (*do, did, are, is, can*), then *you* and the verb. Fill it with four examples in different tenses: *Where do you live? What did you do last weekend? What are you going to do after class? Can you cook?*
3. Drill each question chorally, then in halves of the room, then individually. Use backchaining for long questions: *after class? / do after class? / going to do after class? / What are you going to do after class?*
4. Hand out E2-1A. Learners write the full questions for section A alone.
5. Check on the board. Then drill again from the handout with the paper turned over: you say the prompt, they say the question.
6. Remind the class that in Task 1 they ask their partner, not the assessor. Eye contact goes to the partner.

Activity 2: Answer plus one more thing (25 minutes)

1. Ask a strong learner: "Where do you live?" Take the short answer. Then model a better one yourself: "I live in Dalston. It's busy, but I like it because the market is near." Ask what you added. Board the rule: *answer + one more thing*.
2. Board four ways to add one more thing: a reason (*because*), an example (*for example*), a time (*every Saturday*), a feeling (*I like it / I don't like it*).
3. In pairs, learners ask and answer the six questions from E2-1A. The partner holds up one finger for a short answer and two for an answer with something extra. The speaker tries again until they get two fingers.
4. Mingle: learners stand and ask three different classmates three questions each. They complete section B of the handout with what they learn.
5. Feedback: ask five learners to report one thing about a classmate, using *he* or *she*. Correct the third person *s* on the board.

Activity 3: A one-minute talk (30 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Explain Task 2: the assessor gives a topic about everyday life, and each learner speaks alone. There is no time to prepare, so learners need a shape they can use for any topic.
2. Draw a hand on the board. Thumb: say the topic. Three middle fingers: three things about it. Little finger: finish with a feeling or opinion. Label it *start, three things, finish*.
3. Model a talk on *My weekend* using the hand, touching each finger as you speak. Speak for about one minute. Include one past sentence and one future sentence: "Last Saturday I went to the market. Next weekend I'm going to visit my friend."
4. Ask learners what three things you said. This shows them that the listener needs clear points.
5. Hand out E2-1B. Learners make notes, single words only, for the topic *My neighbourhood*. Give them two minutes.
6. In pairs, A talks for one minute while B times. Then swap. Then change partners and repeat with a new topic card and no notes.

Activity 4: The listener's two questions (20 minutes)

1. Explain that after the talk, the partner must ask two questions. Learners who listen without a plan often cannot think of any.

2. Board the easy route: listen for one thing, then ask *when, where, who with, why* or *how often* about it. Model: you heard “I go to the park”, so you ask “Who do you go with?” and “How often do you go?”
3. Fishbowl: two confident learners sit at the front. One gives a talk from a topic card. The class listens and each person writes one question. Take five questions from the class and board the best two.
4. Back in pairs with new topic cards: one talks, the other asks two questions. The speaker must answer with one more thing, as in Activity 2.

Activity 5: Paired mock of Tasks 1 and 2 (20 minutes)

1. Put learners in groups of three: two candidates and one observer. Give the observer the checklist on E2-1B.
2. Task 1, three minutes: candidates ask each other for personal information. The observer ticks the checklist.
3. Task 2, four minutes: the observer picks a topic card. Each candidate talks, and the partner asks two questions.
4. The observer gives feedback from the checklist: one thing done well, one thing to improve. Rotate roles so everyone is observed once.
5. Close as a class: ask what was hardest. Set the homework: give a one-minute talk to the mirror or a friend on two topic cards.

Handout E2-1A: Asking for personal information

Section A. Write the full question.

Prompt	Full question
Where / live?	
Who / live with?	
What / like doing in your free time?	
What food / not like?	
What / do last weekend?	
What / going to do after class?	

Section B. Ask three classmates. Write short notes.

Name	Lives in	Likes	Does not like	Last weekend

Answer plus one more thing. Use one of these:

- … because …
- … for example …
- … every day / at the weekend / on Mondays …
- I like it. / I don’t like it very much.

Handout E2-1B: The one-minute talk

Start: I’m going to talk about _____.

Three things:

1. First, _____
2. Also, _____

3. Last week / Next week _____

Finish: I like it because _____. / I don't like it very much because _____.

Topic cards (cut up)

My weekend	My neighbourhood	Food I like	A friend or family member
My free time	My English class	Shopping	My daily routine

Questions for the listener

- When do you …?
- Where do you …?
- Who do you … with?
- Why do you like …?
- How often do you …?
- Did you … last week?

Observer checklist

	Candidate A	Candidate B
Asked full questions with a helper word		
Gave answers with one more thing		
Talked alone with a start, three things and a finish		
Used a past or future sentence		
Asked two questions after the partner's talk		
Looked at the partner		

Answer key, E2 Lesson 1

- **E2-1A Section A:** Where do you live? Who do you live with? What do you like doing in your free time? What food don't you like? What did you do last weekend? What are you going to do after class?

Entry 2 Speaking and Listening, Lesson 2: Describing people, places and things

Learners finish able to describe a picture for about a minute in an organised way: the whole scene first, then the people, the place and the things in it, then an opinion. This prepares Task 3.

Materials: Handout E2-2A, one per learner. Eight printed colour photos, A4 if possible, numbered on the back: a street market with stalls and shoppers; a family eating together at home; a busy bus stop in the rain; a park with children playing; a kitchen with someone cooking; a classroom with adult students; a high street with shops; a living room with a sofa, table and television. One extra photo to project or hold up for modelling. Plain paper for drawing.

Activity 1: Whole, parts, opinion (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Show the modelling photo. Ask: "What can you see?" Take single words and write them around the board with no order.
2. Now describe the picture yourself for one minute in an organised way. Start with the whole scene, move from left to right, describe one person in detail, and finish with an opinion.

3. Ask what you said first, next and last. Board the three stages: *the whole picture; the parts; my opinion*.
4. Build the language under each stage with the class. Whole: *This is a picture of… It is in a… I think it is morning.* Parts: *On the left there is… In the middle there are… At the back I can see… She is wearing… He is carrying…* Opinion: *I think they are… because… I like this picture because… It looks…*
5. Drill the position phrases with gestures. Point left, right, middle, front, back and have learners call the phrase. Then reverse: you say the phrase, they point.
6. Check the grammar that the assessor listens for: *there is* with one thing and *there are* with more than one; *is* or *are* plus the *-ing* verb for actions happening now. Board two wrong sentences, *There is three people* and *He wear a hat*, and have the class correct them.

Activity 2: Model description with gaps (20 minutes)

1. Hand out E2-2A. Learners read the description in section A and fill the gaps from the box, alone.
2. Pairs compare. Check as a class by reading the text aloud and pausing at each gap for the class to call the word.
3. Ask learners to mark the three stages in the margin: W for whole, P for parts, O for opinion.
4. Pairs read the completed description aloud to each other, one sentence each in turn. Listen for *there is* and *there are* and correct on the spot.

Activity 3: Describe and draw (25 minutes)

1. Seat pairs back to back. Give A a photo and B a sheet of plain paper.
2. A describes the photo for three minutes. B draws what they hear and may ask questions: “Where is the woman? What is she wearing? How many people are there?”
3. Pairs compare the drawing with the photo. They find three things that are different and say them aloud: “In the photo there are two children, but in the drawing there is one.”
4. Swap roles with a new photo.
5. Feedback: ask which words were missing when learners got stuck. Board them. These are usually position words and clothes.

Activity 4: Better words for people, places and things (20 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Draw three columns on the board: *people, places, things*. Ask learners to complete section B of the handout by sorting the adjectives into the columns. Some words fit in more than one.
2. Check and drill the pronunciation of *crowded, comfortable, friendly* and *modern*.
3. Teach comparing in one line each: *The market is busier than the park. The sofa is more comfortable than the chair.* Short words add *-er*; long words use *more*.
4. Pairs take two photos and make three comparing sentences. Hear one from each pair.

Activity 5: Exam simulation (30 minutes)

1. Explain the task: each learner gets a picture and describes it to their partner and the assessor. Aim for about a minute without stopping.
2. Groups of three: speaker, partner, timekeeper. The speaker takes a photo they have not seen. The timekeeper gives ten seconds to look, then starts the clock.
3. The speaker describes the picture using whole, parts, opinion. The partner listens and then asks one question about it.
4. The timekeeper reports the time and gives feedback from section C of the handout.
5. Rotate until everyone has spoken twice with different photos. Move between groups and note common errors.
6. Last five minutes: board five errors you heard, without names. The class corrects them together.

Handout E2-2A: Describing a picture

Section A. Complete the description with words from the box.

are | wearing | left | behind | is | carrying | because | middle

This is a picture of a street market. I think it is Saturday morning because it is very busy. On the (1) _____ there is a fruit stall with apples, oranges and bananas. A man is standing (2) _____ the stall. He is (3) _____ a blue jacket and a hat. In the (4) _____ of the picture there (5) _____ two women. They are talking and laughing. One woman is (6) _____ a heavy shopping bag. On the right there (7) _____ a small boy. He is eating an apple. I like this picture (8) _____ everyone looks happy.

Section B. Write each word under People, Places or Things. Some words can go in two columns.

tall | crowded | friendly | quiet | heavy | young | modern | comfortable | busy | old | expensive | tired

People	Places	Things

Section C. Timekeeper's feedback. Tick what you heard.

	Yes	Not yet
Started with the whole picture		
Used left, right, middle, front or back		
Used there is and there are		
Said what people are doing and wearing		
Finished with an opinion		
Spoke for about one minute		

Answer key, E2 Lesson 2

- **Section A:** 1 left, 2 behind, 3 wearing, 4 middle, 5 are, 6 carrying, 7 is, 8 because.
- **Section B, suggested:** People: tall, friendly, young, old, tired, busy, quiet. Places: crowded, quiet, modern, busy, old, expensive. Things: heavy, modern, comfortable, old, expensive.

Entry 2 Speaking and Listening, Lesson 3: Listening, discussion and full mock

Learners finish able to answer a yes/no question about the general idea of a short spoken text, catch one detail, and take part in a short three-way discussion on the topic. This prepares Task 4 and rehearses the whole exam.

Materials: Handout E2-3A, one per learner. The teacher's scripts below, not given to learners until Activity 3. If a colleague or strong learner can read the second voice in the dialogues, use them. If not, change your position and voice for each speaker.

Activity 1: Know the question before you listen (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Explain Task 4: the assessor plays two short recordings. For each one, every learner answers a yes/no question about the general idea and one question about a detail. Then everyone discusses a topic from the recordings.

2. Write on the board: *Is there a class today?* Ask what kind of answer it needs. Then write: *Which room is the class in?* Ask what kind of word the answer will be. Establish: a yes/no question needs the general idea; a *wh*- question needs one fact, often a number, time, day or place.
3. Quick sort. Read out eight questions. Learners hold up one hand for yes/no and two for detail: *Is the shop open? What time does it close? Does he like the food? Where is she going? How much is it? Are they friends? Which day is the party? Is the bus late?*
4. Teach short answers, which most learners get wrong under pressure. Board the pattern: *Is…? Yes, it is. / No, it isn't. Does…? Yes, she does. / No, she doesn't. Are…? Yes, they are. / No, they aren't.* Drill fast around the room with your eight questions.
5. Teach the listening routine: first time, listen for the general idea and do not write; second time, listen for numbers, times, days and places.

Activity 2: Two listening texts (25 minutes)

1. Read Script A at natural speed. Learners only listen. Ask the yes/no question to the whole class and take a show of hands.
2. Read Script A again. Learners write answers to the detail questions on the handout, section A.
3. Check in pairs, then as a class. Ask learners which words told them the answer. For the room question, point out the trap: Room 12 is mentioned, but the class is not in it. Recordings often give a wrong detail before the right one.
4. Repeat the same steps with Script B.
5. Ask learners to answer in full sentences aloud: "No, there isn't. The teacher is ill." The assessor hears spoken answers, so written notes are only a support.

Activity 3: Rebuild the text (20 minutes)

1. Read Script B a third time at natural speed. Learners write down only key words: names, numbers, food, times.
2. In pairs, learners rebuild the dialogue from their key words and write it out. It does not need to be word for word, but the meaning must be the same.
3. Give out the script from the handout, section C. Pairs compare their version and underline anything they missed.
4. Pairs read the dialogue aloud, then swap roles. Fast pairs change three details, such as the day, the food and the time, and perform their new version.

Activity 4: Three-way discussion (25 minutes, teacher-led then groups)

1. Explain that the exam ends with a short discussion between the assessor and both learners about a topic from the recordings. The assessor wants to hear opinions, reasons and learners speaking to each other.
2. Board three sets of phrases. Opinion: *I think… In my opinion…* Reason: *…because…* Involving the partner: *What about you? Do you agree? What do you think?* Responding: *I agree. I'm not sure. I don't agree, because…*
3. Model with a strong learner on the topic of neighbours. Ask: "Is it important to know your neighbours?" Give an opinion and a reason, then turn the question to the learner.
4. Groups of three. One learner plays the assessor and reads the discussion questions from the handout, section B. The other two discuss each question for one minute. Rule: nobody may answer without then asking the partner something.
5. Rotate the assessor role after two questions.
6. Feedback: ask which groups disagreed about something. Have them repeat that exchange for the class. Polite disagreement is worth showing.

Activity 5: Full mock exam (30 minutes)

1. Groups of three: two candidates and one assessor. The assessor gets the mock card on the handout, section D, and Scripts C and D.

2. Run all four tasks in shortened form. Task 1, two minutes: ask each other for personal information. Task 2, three minutes: one-minute talk each, two questions from the partner. Task 3, three minutes: each describes one photo from last lesson. Task 4, five minutes: the assessor reads Scripts C and D and asks the questions, then one discussion question.
3. The assessor gives each candidate one strength and one target.
4. Rotate once so that at least two learners in each group have been candidates. The third candidate goes first next lesson.
5. Close as a class. Tell learners the real exam is about 25 minutes, in pairs, with a friendly assessor, and that they may ask for a question to be repeated: “Sorry, can you say that again, please?” Drill the sentence.

Teacher’s scripts

Script A (voicemail). Hello, this is a message for the Tuesday English class. This is Carol from the college office. I’m sorry, but your teacher is ill today, so there is no class this afternoon. The next class is on Thursday at half past one. It is not in Room 12. It is in Room 20, on the second floor. Please bring your student card. Thank you. Goodbye.

- Yes/no: Is there a class this afternoon? (No, there isn’t.)
- Detail: Which room is the next class in? (Room 20.) What time does it start? (Half past one.) What must students bring? (Their student card.)

Script B (two neighbours).

- A: Hi Sara. Are you going to the street party on Saturday?
- B: Yes, I am. I went last year and it was great. Are you coming?
- A: I’d like to, but I don’t know what to bring.
- B: Everyone brings some food. I’m going to make rice and chicken.
- A: I can’t cook very well. Can I bring drinks?
- B: Good idea. Bring some juice. There are a lot of children.
- A: OK. What time does it start?
- B: At two o’clock, outside number 15.
- Yes/no: Is Sara going to the party? (Yes, she is.)
- Detail: What is Sara going to make? (Rice and chicken.) What is the man going to bring? (Juice.) What time does the party start? (Two o’clock.)

Script C (library announcement), for the mock. Good afternoon. The library closes in fifteen minutes, at five o’clock. If you want to borrow books, please go to the desk now. The computers will turn off in five minutes. Tomorrow we open at nine. Thank you.

- Yes/no: Is the library closing soon? (Yes, it is.)
- Detail: What time does it open tomorrow? (Nine o’clock.)

Script D (doctor’s reception), for the mock.

- A: Good morning. Can I help you?
- B: Yes, I’d like an appointment with the doctor, please.
- A: Is it urgent?
- B: No, not really. I have a pain in my back.
- A: OK. The doctor is free on Wednesday at quarter past ten or Friday at four.
- B: Friday is better. I have a class on Wednesday.
- A: Fine. Friday at four. What’s your name?
- B: Yusuf Ali.
- Yes/no: Is the problem urgent? (No, it isn’t.)
- Detail: Which day is the appointment? (Friday.)

Handout E2-3A: Listening and discussion

Section A. Listen and answer.

	Question	Answer
Text 1	Is there a class this afternoon?	
	Which room is the next class in?	
	What time does it start?	
	What must students bring?	
Text 2	Is Sara going to the party?	
	What is Sara going to make?	
	What is the man going to bring?	
	What time does the party start?	

Section B. Discussion questions.

1. Is it important to know your neighbours? Why?
2. Do you like parties? What do you do at a party?
3. What food do you make for visitors?
4. What do you do when your class is cancelled?
5. Is it easy to see a doctor in London? Why?
6. Do you use the library? What for?

Useful phrases: I think … because … | What about you? | Do you agree? | I agree. | I'm not sure. | I don't agree, because …

Section C. The dialogue.

- A: Hi Sara. Are you going to the street party on Saturday?
- B: Yes, I am. I went last year and it was great. Are you coming?
- A: I'd like to, but I don't know what to bring.
- B: Everyone brings some food. I'm going to make rice and chicken.
- A: I can't cook very well. Can I bring drinks?
- B: Good idea. Bring some juice. There are a lot of children.
- A: OK. What time does it start?
- B: At two o'clock, outside number 15.

Section D. Mock exam card for the assessor.

Task	What you say	Time
1	Please ask your partner some questions about where they live and what they like.	2 minutes
2	Please talk about your free time. Then your partner will ask you two questions.	3 minutes
3	Please describe this picture to	3 minutes

Task	What you say	Time
	your partner.	
4	Listen. Then answer my questions. After that: Do you use the library or the doctor more often? Why?	5 minutes

Section C is given out in Activity 3 only. Fold it under or cut it off before the lesson.

Entry 1 Speaking and Listening, Lesson 1: Asking for personal information

Learners finish able to ask a partner six personal questions clearly, answer in full sentences, and say what they like and do not like. This prepares Task 1, where learners question each other and the assessor then asks a few more questions.

Materials: Handouts E1-1A and E1-1B, one per learner. Word cards for Activity 3, one set per pair, cut from the grid in E1-1B. A soft ball or rolled-up paper.

Activity 1: The six questions (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Draw a ladder with six steps on the board. Write one question on each step, from the bottom up: *What's your name? Where are you from? Where do you live? Who do you live with? What do you like? What don't you like?*
2. Say each question. Learners repeat together three times: slowly, at normal speed, then quietly. Use backchaining for the longer ones: *live with? / do you live with? / Who do you live with?*
3. Clap the stress so the questions sound natural: WHERE do you LIVE? WHO do you LIVE with?
4. Answer each question about yourself in a full sentence. Write your answers beside the ladder: *My name is… I'm from… I live in… I live with… I like… I don't like…*
5. Ball game. Throw the ball to a learner and ask question 1. They answer, then throw the ball to someone else and ask question 2. Continue up the ladder and start again at the bottom. Keep going until everyone has asked and answered at least twice.
6. Rub out one word from each question. Play again. Then rub out another. By the end, learners are asking from memory.

Activity 2: My dialogue (25 minutes)

1. Hand out E1-1A. Read the dialogue aloud with a strong learner. You are A, they are B, and you fill the gaps with real information as you speak.
2. Show the choices on the handout. Read both options for each and ask who each one is true for. Example: "I live with my family" or "I live alone". Make it clear that every answer is a good answer. Learners choose the sentence that is true for them.
3. Learners complete the B lines with their own information. Walk round and help with spelling. Learners who have no hobby use the line "I don't have a hobby, but I like…" and add food, music, a place or a person.
4. Pairs read the dialogue aloud. A asks, B answers from their handout. Then they swap roles.
5. Pairs turn the handout over and try again without reading. They may look only if they are stuck.
6. Two or three pairs perform for the class. Praise full sentences.

Activity 3: Put the question in order (20 minutes)

1. Give each pair a set of word cards for one question, mixed up, for example *do / where / you / live*. They put the words in order on the desk.
2. Check each pair, then they pass the cards to the next pair and take a new set. Continue until every pair has built all six questions.
3. Board the pattern in three boxes: *question word / do / you + verb*. Show that *What's your name?* and *Where are you from?* are different because they use *is* and *are*.

4. Learners write the six questions in section A of E1-1B from memory, then check against the board.

Activity 4: Class survey (25 minutes)

1. Show the survey grid in section B of E1-1B. Model with one learner: ask the questions and write short answers in the grid on the board.
2. Learners stand, find three classmates, and ask each one four questions. They write one or two words only for each answer.
3. Listen for missing *do* and for one-word answers. Do not interrupt. Note the errors.
4. Learners sit down. Ask several to tell the class about one person: "This is Ali. He is from… He lives in… He likes…" Write *he lives, she likes* on the board and underline the *s*.
5. Board three errors you heard. The class corrects them together.

Activity 5: Exam practice with the teacher's questions (25 minutes)

1. Explain the exam in simple words and with gestures: two students, one assessor. First, the students ask each other questions. Then the assessor asks some more.
2. Teach two rescue sentences and drill them: *Sorry, can you repeat that, please?* and *Sorry, I don't understand.*
3. Bring one pair to the front. They ask each other the six questions. Then you ask each of them two extra questions from this list: *Do you like London? What food do you like? Do you like your English class? What do you do on Sunday?*
4. The class listens and gives a thumbs up for each full sentence.
5. All pairs now practise together. Move round the room and play the assessor for each pair in turn, asking two extra questions.
6. Finish with the ladder. Point to each step, and the class asks the question together from memory.

Handout E1-1A: My dialogue

A asks. B answers. Choose the sentence that is true for you and write your words.

Speaker	Say
A	Hello. What's your name?
B	My name is _____.
A	Where are you from?
B	I'm from _____.
A	Where do you live?
B	I live in _____.
A	Who do you live with?
B	I live with my _____. **or** I live alone.
A	What do you like?
B	I like _____. **or** I don't have a hobby, but I like _____.
A	What don't you like?
B	I don't like _____.
A	Thank you.

Words to help you

- Family: husband, wife, son, daughter, children, mother, father, sister, brother, friend
- I like: cooking, football, music, walking, shopping, films, reading, sleeping, tea, my class
- I don't like: rain, cold weather, getting up early, the bus, noise, coffee, fish

Handout E1-1B: Questions

Section A. Write the six questions.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Section B. Ask three students.

Name	From	Lives in	Likes	Does not like

Word cards for Activity 3 (teacher cuts up one set per pair and keeps each question in its own envelope)

What	is	your	name	?
Where	are	you	from	?
Where	do	you	live	?
Who	do	you	live with	?
What	do	you	like	?
What	don't	you	like	?

Entry 1 Speaking and Listening, Lesson 2: The short talk and describing a picture

Learners finish able to say four or five connected sentences about a familiar topic, ask a partner two simple questions about their talk, and describe a picture using *there is, there are*, colours, numbers and simple actions. This prepares Tasks 2 and 3.

Materials: Handouts E1-2A and E1-2B, one per learner. Six printed colour photos with few, clear details, numbered on the back: a family at a table; a woman shopping at a fruit stall; children in a park; a man cooking; a bus with people getting on; a classroom. One extra photo for modelling. A timer.

Activity 1: Five sentences about me (30 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Tell the class: "In the exam, the assessor gives you a topic. You talk. Your partner listens." Write three exam topics on the board: *my family and friends, my free time, things I like and don't like*.
2. Hold up five fingers. Give a talk on *my family and friends* with one sentence per finger: "I'm going to talk about my family. I have one sister. She lives in Leeds. She is a nurse. I like my family very much." Repeat it, with learners counting the sentences on their fingers.
3. Board the frame from E1-2A with gaps. Build a talk together for one learner by asking them questions and writing their answers into the frame.
4. Hand out E1-2A. Learners choose one topic and complete the frame for themselves. Learners with no family in the UK can talk about a friend, a neighbour or a classmate. Say this clearly, so that nobody feels stuck.
5. Learners practise their talk quietly alone, touching one finger for each sentence.

6. Pairs: A gives the talk, B counts the sentences on their fingers. Then swap. Then change partners and repeat without the paper.

Activity 2: Two questions for my partner (20 minutes)

1. Explain with gestures: after the talk, the partner asks two questions.
2. Board four easy question starters: *Do you like…? Where is…? What is his/her name? How many…?* Drill each one.
3. Give your five-sentence talk again. Stop, and ask the class for questions. Take four or five and answer them. Write the best two on the board.
4. Pairs: A gives the talk, B asks two questions from the question box on E1-2A, A answers. Swap.
5. Hear three pairs. If a learner asks a question the talk already answered, praise the question and show how to choose a different one.

Activity 3: What can you see? (30 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Hold up the modelling photo. Ask: "What can you see?" Accept single words. Write them on the board with *a* or the number: *a woman, two children, a table*.
2. Turn the words into sentences. Board the two patterns: *There is a woman. There are two children.* Drill with different nouns from the photo. Learners clap once for *is* and twice for *are*.
3. Add colour and size: *There is a big red bus. There are two small children.* Ask five quick colour questions about things in the room.
4. Add actions. Board: *He is cooking. She is shopping. They are playing.* Mime six actions, such as eating, drinking, walking, reading, sitting and talking. The class calls out the sentence.
5. Describe the modelling photo yourself in five sentences, one per finger: what it is, who is there, what there is, what they are doing, whether you like it.
6. Hand out E1-2B. Learners complete section A, choosing *is* or *are*, then check in pairs and as a class.

Activity 4: Describe my picture (25 minutes)

1. Give each pair one photo. Together they write five sentences about it in section B of the handout, using the sentence builder.
2. Pairs join another pair. They show their photo and say their sentences without reading if they can. The other pair listens and points to each thing in the photo as they hear it.
3. Swap photos between groups and repeat, this time speaking without writing first.
4. Game: put all six photos on the board. Describe one in three sentences without saying which. Learners call out the number. Then learners take turns to describe one for the class to guess.

Activity 5: Mini exam, Tasks 2 and 3 (15 minutes)

1. Groups of three: two candidates, one listener.
2. Task 2: the listener says a topic. Each candidate gives the five-sentence talk and the partner asks two questions.
3. Task 3: the listener gives each candidate a photo. Each candidate says five sentences about it.
4. The listener holds up fingers to count sentences and shows the number at the end. Five fingers is the target.
5. Close as a class. Ask: "How many sentences?" The class answers: "Five." Homework: describe one picture on their phone to a friend or family member in English.

Handout E1-2A: My talk

Choose a topic: **my family and friends | my free time | things I like and don't like**

Finger	Sentence
1	I'm going to talk about _____.
2	I have _____. **or** I like

Finger	Sentence
	_____.
3	He / She / It is _____.
4	He / She lives in _____. **or** I do this on _____.
5	I like _____ very much. **or** I don't like _____.

Question box. Ask your partner two questions.

- Do you like _____?
- What is his name? / What is her name?
- Where is he? / Where is she?
- How many _____ do you have?
- When do you _____?

Handout E1-2B: My picture

Section A. Circle *is* or *are*.

1. There **is / are** a woman.
2. There **is / are** three apples.
3. There **is / are** a big table.
4. There **is / are** two children.
5. There **is / are** a red bus.
6. There **is / are** four chairs.
7. The man **is / are** cooking.
8. The children **is / are** playing.

Section B. Write five sentences about your picture. Use the sentence builder.

Start	Number or a	Colour or size	Person or thing
There is	a	big / small	man / woman / boy / girl
There are	two / three / four	red / blue / green / white / black	children / people / chairs / apples

Person	is / are	Action
He / She	is	cooking / eating / shopping / sitting
They	are	playing / talking / walking / reading

1. This is a picture of _____.

2. I like / I don't like this picture.

Answer key, E1 Lesson 2

- **E1-2B Section A:** 1 is, 2 are, 3 is, 4 are, 5 is, 6 are, 7 is, 8 are.

Entry 1 Speaking and Listening, Lesson 3: Listening, discussion and full mock

Learners finish able to answer a yes/no question and a detail question about a very short spoken text, and to give and ask for a simple opinion. This prepares Task 4 and rehearses the whole exam.

Materials: Handout E1-3A, one per learner. Two cards per learner, one marked YES and one marked NO, on coloured paper. The teacher's scripts below. The six photos from Lesson 2 for the mock.

Activity 1: Yes or no? (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Give each learner a YES card and a NO card. Ask ten fast questions about the room and the class. Learners hold up a card: *Is it Monday? Is the door open? Are we in London? Is it raining? Do I have a pen? Is this a hospital?*
2. Now add the spoken short answer. Board four patterns in two colours: *Yes, it is. / No, it isn't. Yes, she does. / No, she doesn't.* Drill each with the card in the air.
3. Show how the question gives the answer. Underline the first word of the question and the last word of the answer: ***Is*** *it…? Yes, it* ***is****.* ***Does*** *she…? No, she* ***doesn't****.*
4. Ask the ten questions again. This time learners hold up the card and say the short answer together.
5. Pairs ask each other five yes/no questions from section A of the handout and answer with the short answer.

Activity 2: Listen for the idea, then the detail (30 minutes)

1. Explain with gestures: "I read. You listen. No writing." Read Script A slowly and clearly, once.
2. Ask the yes/no question. Learners hold up a card, then say the short answer together.
3. Tell learners the detail question before the second reading: "When does she go to college?" Ask what kind of word to listen for. Establish: days.
4. Read Script A again. Learners write the answer on the handout, section B. Check together.
5. Repeat all four steps with Script B. For the detail, the listening target is a price.
6. Read both scripts a third time while learners follow the gapped version in section C and fill in the missing words. Check by reading aloud together.
7. Pairs read Script B as a dialogue, then swap roles. Fast pairs change the fruit and the price.

Activity 3: What do you think? (25 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Explain that after listening, the assessor asks both learners some easy questions about the topic, and they talk together.
2. Board four phrases and drill them with gestures: *I like… I don't like… What about you? Me too.* Add *because it is…* with three easy endings: *good, cheap, near*.
3. Model with a strong learner. Ask: "Do you like shopping?" Answer yourself: "Yes, I do. I like the market because it is cheap. What about you?"
4. Chain drill around the room. Each learner answers the question, then says "What about you?" to the next person. Change the question every six learners: *Do you like tea? Do you like your college? Do you like the bus?*
5. Pairs discuss the four questions in section D of the handout. Rule: every answer ends with "What about you?"
6. Hear four pairs. Praise any learner who adds *because*.

Activity 4: Full mock exam (35 minutes)

1. Groups of three: two candidates and one helper. You play the assessor for one group at a time for Task 4. The helper runs Tasks 1 to 3 from the mock card in section E.
2. Task 1, two minutes: candidates ask each other the six questions from Lesson 1.
3. Task 2, three minutes: the helper says the topic. Each candidate gives the five-sentence talk. The partner asks two questions.
4. Task 3, two minutes: each candidate describes a photo in five sentences.

5. Task 4, four minutes: come to the group. Read Script C and ask one candidate the yes/no question and the other the detail question. Read Script D and swap. Then ask one discussion question to both.
6. While you are with one group, the others repeat Tasks 1 to 3 with roles rotated, so nobody is waiting.
7. Give each candidate one thing they did well and one target, in very simple words.

Activity 5: Ready for the exam (10 minutes)

1. Tell the class what will happen on the day, with gestures and simple words: two students, one assessor, about 22 minutes, four parts.
2. Drill the two rescue sentences again: *Sorry, can you repeat that, please?* and *Sorry, I don't understand.*
3. Board three rules and have learners copy them: *Say full sentences. Look at your partner. Ask if you don't understand.*

Teacher's scripts

Script A. Hello. My name is Fatima. I live in Hackney with my sister. I go to college on Monday and Wednesday. I like my class. My teacher is very nice.

- Yes/no: Does Fatima live with her sister? (Yes, she does.)
- Detail: When does she go to college? (On Monday and Wednesday.)

Script B.

- A: Hello. Can I help you?
- B: Yes, please. How much are the apples?
- A: They are one pound a bag.
- B: Two bags, please.
- A: That's two pounds.
- B: Here you are. Thank you.
- Yes/no: Is the woman buying bananas? (No, she isn't.)
- Detail: How much is one bag? (One pound.)

Script C, for the mock. Hi Sam. It's Ali. I am at the bus stop. The bus is late. I am coming to your house at six o'clock. See you soon.

- Yes/no: Is the bus late? (Yes, it is.)
- Detail: What time is Ali coming? (Six o'clock.)

Script D, for the mock.

- A: Do you like tea?
- B: No, I don't. I like coffee.
- A: Milk and sugar?
- B: Milk, please. No sugar.
- Yes/no: Does the woman like tea? (No, she doesn't.)
- Detail: What does she want in her coffee? (Milk.)
- Discussion: What do you like to drink? Do you take the bus?

Handout E1-3A: Listening and talking

Section A. Ask your partner. Answer: Yes, I do. / No, I don't. / Yes, I am. / No, I'm not.

1. Do you like tea?
2. Do you live in Hackney?
3. Are you tired today?
4. Do you like football?

5. Are you from London?

Section B. Listen and write.

	Question	Answer
Text 1	Does Fatima live with her sister?	
	When does she go to college?	
Text 2	Is the woman buying bananas?	
	How much is one bag?	

Section C. Listen again. Write the words.

Hello. My name is Fatima. I live in Hackney with my _____. I go to college on _____ and _____. I like my class. My _____ is very nice.

- A: Hello. Can I help you?
- B: Yes, please. How much are the _____?
- A: They are _____ pound a bag.
- B: _____ bags, please.
- A: That's two pounds.
- B: Here you are. Thank you.

Section D. Talk with your partner. Finish with: What about you?

1. Do you like shopping?
2. What food do you like?
3. Do you like your college?
4. Who do you live with?

Section E. Mock exam card for the helper.

Part	Say this
1	Please ask your partner some questions.
2	Please talk about things you like and don't like. Then your partner asks two questions.
3	Please tell us about this picture.
4	Wait for the teacher.

Answer key, E1 Lesson 3

- **Section B:** Yes, she does. On Monday and Wednesday. No, she isn't. One pound.
- **Section C:** sister, Monday, Wednesday, teacher; apples, one, Two.